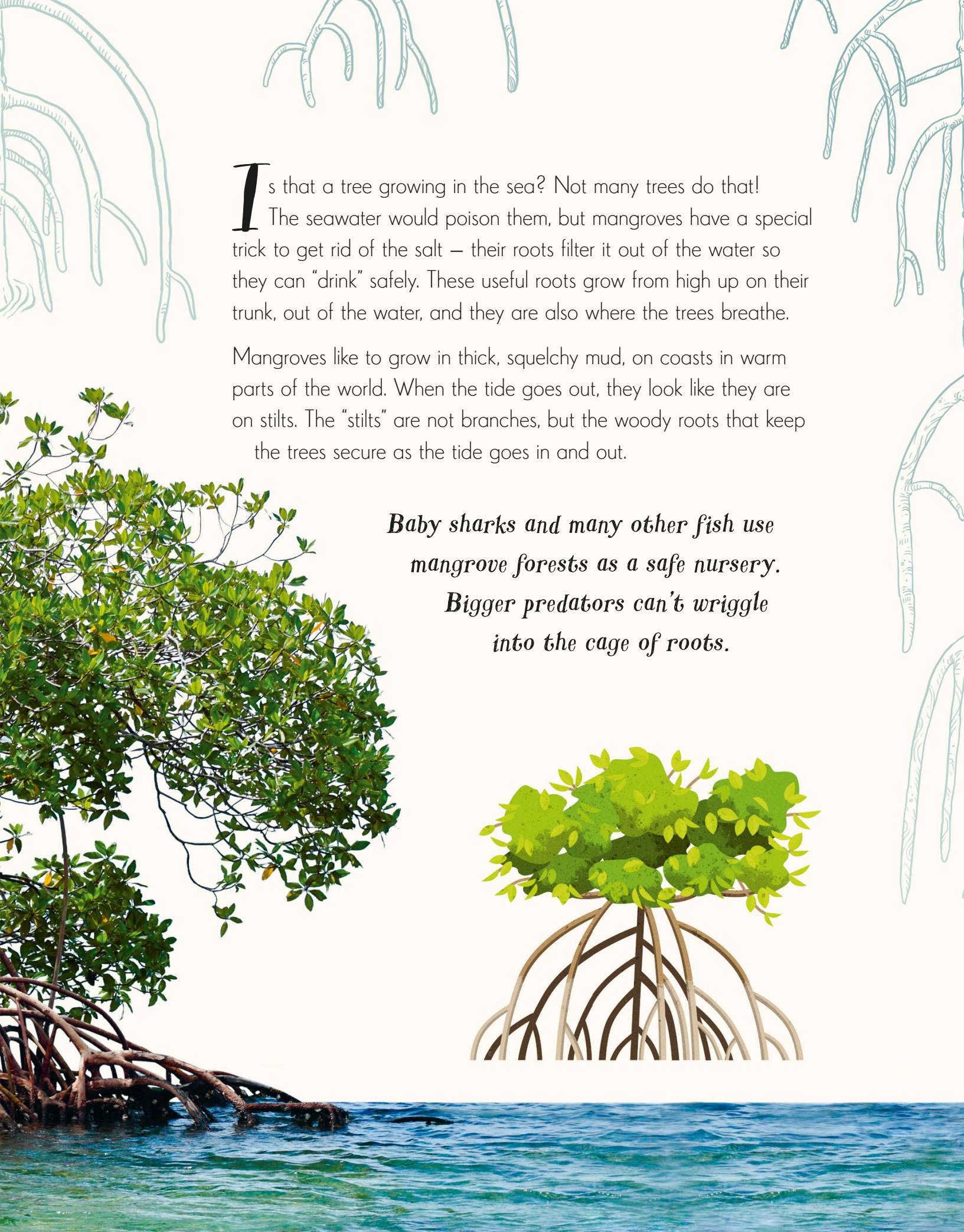




Is that a tree growing in the sea? Not many trees do that! The seawater would poison them, but mangroves have a special trick to get rid of the salt — their roots filter it out of the water so they can “drink” safely. These useful roots grow from high up on their trunk, out of the water, and they are also where the trees breathe.

Mangroves like to grow in thick, squelchy mud, on coasts in warm parts of the world. When the tide goes out, they look like they are on stilts. The “stilts” are not branches, but the woody roots that keep the trees secure as the tide goes in and out.

*Baby sharks and many other fish use
mangrove forests as a safe nursery.
Bigger predators can't wriggle
into the cage of roots.*

